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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am a Computer Science senior at the University of Nevada, Las Vegas, graduating in December, and I begin an online Master's in Computer Science with a machine learning specialization in January 2027. I am applying for the Software Engineer I role at Affirm. Most of what I know came from building things end to end and dealing with the problems that showed up after they were live.

My senior design project, FOMO, is an event discovery app that won 1st place at UNLV's CS Senior Design competition and is live on the App Store with over 100 installs. I worked on a team of 11 and owned the recommendation system. I designed the backend data layer, exposing an authenticated HTTP API between our Python ML code and the database. Our original per-user query pattern hit platform usage limits and weight recomputation was taking over 30 seconds, so I rearchitected it with batched endpoints and dirty-check incremental updates. That brought recomputation to sub-second and let the pipeline run every 15 minutes inside quota. I also built the recommendation engine itself, a two-tower retrieval model with a multi-signal re-ranker.

Since finishing it in May I have been building Meridiem, an SMS lead follow-up platform for small businesses, deployed at meridiemflow.com. I wrote the multi-tenant backend, which validates Twilio webhook signatures, routes each text to the company that owns the number, and ignores duplicate provider events so a carrier retry never double-texts a customer. The decision I care most about is that the model never sends anything itself. The LLM returns a typed decision that Pydantic validates, and application code decides whether to send, whether the lead changes stage, and whether a person takes over. Malformed output or a failed API call escalates to a human, and STOP and emergency keywords are matched in code before the model runs.

I am currently fine-tuning a vision language model to read freight rate confirmations. My family’s trucking company retypes the same fields off each PDF into several pages of a factoring portal, so I am building a Chrome extension that fills those forms from an upload.

I am excited to contribute to your team, learn from experienced engineers, and apply my skills to real production systems. Thank you for considering my application, and I would be glad to speak further about how I could help.

Sincerely,
Manjot Sandhu
University of Nevada, Las Vegas | B.S. Computer Science